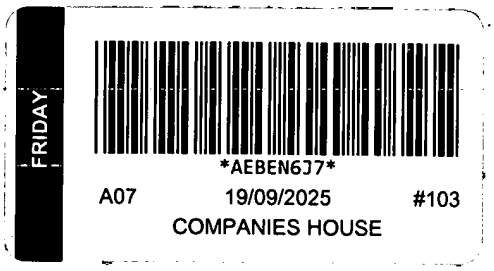
Registration Number: 01404552

PizzaExpress Limited

Annual Report and Financial statements

For the 52-week period ended 29 December 2024



Company Information

Directors

P MacKenzie
C Elliot
M Sandhu

Company Secretary

M Sandhu

Registration Number

01404552

Registered office

PizzaExpress
Building 01
Arc Uxbridge
Sanderson Road
Uxbridge
United Kingdom
UB8 1DH

Independent auditors

PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP
40 Clarendon Road
Watford
Hertfordshire
WD17 1JJ

PizzaExpress Limited
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The Board of Directors (the "Directors") present their Strategic Report along with the audited financial statements (the "financial statements") for PizzaExpress Limited ("the Company") for the 52-week period ended 29 December 2024 (the "period"). The comparative period is the 52-week period ended 31 December 2023.

Review of the business

The Company is a holding Company and does not carry out any trading activity.

The loss after tax for the financial period amounted to £5,307,000 (period ended 31 December 2023: £1,948,000 profit) which included an impairment charge of £11,182,000 on intercompany receivables (period ended 31 December 2023: £4,468,000 charge). The Company was in a net liability position of £74,530,000 at 29 December 2024 (as at 31 December 2023: £69,223,000) and a cash position of £17,375,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £3,435,000).

The consolidated financial statements of Wheel Topco Limited (the ultimate parent Company and the largest group in which the results of the Company are consolidated) provide detail on the Group's future business plans.

As at 29 December 2024, the Company's intermediate parent Wheel Bidco Limited has in place £335,000,000 of 6.75% 5 year bonds due to mature in July 2026 (the "Existing Notes"), and an additional revolving credit facility ("RCF") of £30,000,000. At 29 December 2024, £26,000,000 of the RCF is available to be drawn until January 2026, as £4,000,000 is utilised to provide a letter of credit to a utility provider which has not been called (31 December 2023: £26,000,000 undrawn). The Company is a guarantor to these facilities and further details of the guarantee can be found in note 20.

On 28 May 2025, the Group successfully completed its debt refinancing. To strengthen the balance sheet of the Group, certain of the Group's shareholders provided the Group with £20,000,000 of new equity. The proceeds of which the Group used together with £35,000,000 of balance sheet cash, to fund a £55,000,000 pro rata par cash paydown of the existing £335,000,000 senior secured notes.

In addition, the Group announced that it had reached agreement with existing noteholders, to extend maturities of the remaining senior secured notes until September 2029. The extended notes carry a coupon of 9.875% per annum paid biannually. In connection with the refinancing, the Group has amended and extended the Revolving Credit Facility, whereby £24,750,000 of the existing facility has been extended to March 2029, and the remaining £5,250,000 of the existing facility is available until January 2026. On completion of the refinancing, the Group now has in place £280,000,000 of Senior Secured Notes at a coupon of 9.875%, together with the Revolving Credit Facility.

Key performance indicators

Given the holding company nature of the business, the Company's Directors are of the opinion that analysis using KPIs is not necessary for an understanding of the development, performance or position of the business. This is achieved instead through its operating subsidiaries, the performance of which are measured through the use of three key performance indicators being sales growth, profitability versus annual budget and the number of restaurants.

Principal risks and uncertainties

The Directors have the primary responsibility for identifying the principal risks that the Company face and for developing appropriate policies to manage those risks. The key risk to the Company is as follows:

- Liquidity risk
  The Company manages this risk by obtaining assurances from Wheel Topco Limited that it will not seek repayment of intercompany creditors in the foreseeable future. Fixed interest is charged on intercompany balances.

Future developments

The Company will continue to act as a holding Company for the PizzaExpress Group Limited.

This Strategic Report was approved by the Board on 10 July 2025 and signed on its behalf.

Colin Elliot

Colin Elliot (Jul 10, 2025 10:43 GMT+1)
C Elliot
Director

The Directors present their report and audited financial statements for the Company for the 52-week period ended 29 December 2024.

Dividends
The Directors do not recommend payment of a final dividend (period ended 31 December 2023: No final dividend).

Future developments
Details of the Company's future developments are included within the Strategic Report on page 1.

Financial risk management
The Company's activities expose it to financial risks being primarily liquidity risk and foreign exchange risk. Given that the Company has received confirmation of support from a parent company, this is not considered to be a significant risk. Foreign exchange risk may arise from the settlement of future transactions with the Company's subsidiary Agenbite Limited, is not considered to be a significant risk. Further detail on financial risk management, including credit, liquidity and cash flow risks, is available in note 21 of the Wheel Topco Limited annual report.

Going concern
The Directors note that as at 29 December 2024, the Company was in a net liability position of £74,530,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £69,223,000) and a net current liability position of £69,963,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £64,712,000). The Directors consider the business to continue to meet its obligations as they fall due and remain in business for the foreseeable future. The Company has received confirmation from its ultimate parent company, Wheel Topco Limited in respect of the ability of it and the subsidiaries of the Group to provide financial support as required by the Company to enable it to meet its obligations as they fall due for a period of not less than 12 months from the date of signing these financial statements.

The Directors note that as at 29 December 2024, the Group was in a net asset position of £107,127,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £140,190,000) and a net current liability position of £11,553,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £13,089,000). The Directors consider the business is able to continue to meet its obligations as they fall due and remain in business for the foreseeable future.

As at 29 December 2024, the Group has in place £335,000,000 of 6.75% 5 year bonds due to mature in July 2026 (the "Existing Notes"), and an additional revolving credit facility ("RCF") of £30,000,000. At 29 December 2024, £26,000,000 of the RCF is available to be drawn until January 2026, as £4,000,000 is utilised to provide a letter of credit to a utility provider which has not been called (31 December 2023: £26,000,000 undrawn).

On 28 May 2025, the Group successfully completed its debt refinancing. To strengthen the balance sheet of the Group, certain of the Group's shareholders provided the Group with £20,000,000 of new equity. The proceeds of which the Group used together with £35,000,000 of balance sheet cash, to fund a £55,000,000 pro rata par cash paydown of the existing £335,000,000 senior secured notes.

In addition, the Group announced that it had reached agreement with existing noteholders, to extend maturities of the remaining senior secured notes until September 2029. The extended notes carry a coupon of 9.875% per annum paid biannually.

In connection with the refinancing, the Group has amended and extended the Revolving Credit Facility, whereby £24,750,000 of the existing facility has been extended to March 2029, and the remaining £5,250,000 of the existing facility is available until January 2026.

On completion of the refinancing, the Group now has in place £280,000,000 of Senior Secured Notes at a coupon of 9.875%, together with the Revolving Credit Facility.

When forming their opinion on the appropriateness of the going concern basis in preparing the financial statements for the Group, the Directors have considered the Group's financing arrangements, trading patterns and trading risks. The Directors have reviewed financial projections for both a base case and a downside case. The downside case assumes a reduction in revenue and a proportion of cost reductions and efficiencies cannot be achieved, resulting in a lower EBITDA and cash flow.

The Group has sufficient liquidity through trading to finance operations for at least the next 12 months in both the base case and downside case scenarios. The Group could further mitigate its liquidity by reducing discretionary capital expenditure and other spend in the period if required.

Having assessed the financial projections, sensitivities and possible mitigating actions, the Board considers that these appropriately demonstrate the ability of the Group to meet its obligations for at least twelve months from the date of signing these financial statements.

Directors
The Directors of the Company who were in office during the period and up to the date of signing the financial statements were:

P MacKenzie
C Elliot (appointed as Director 13 January 2025)
M Sandhu (appointed as Company Secretary 6 April 2024)
J Bennett (resigned as Director and Company Secretary 6 April 2024)

Qualifying third-party indemnity provision
Qualifying third party indemnity provisions as defined by the Companies Act 2006 were in force for the benefit of Directors throughout the period and up to the date of approval of the financial statements.

Financial instruments
The Directors consider that the Company's key financial instruments are cash and amounts due from and due to group companies. Financial exposures exist to the extent that a change in the underlying base rate of interest will affect the level of income received on cash at bank and in hand. This risk is not considered material and thus the Company does not employ the use of hedging instruments. Fixed interest is charged on amounts due from group companies. The Company monitors the credit risk and credit worthiness of Group companies. The Directors will revisit the appropriateness of the policy should the Company's operations change in size or nature. Financial exposures also exist in relation to liquidity risk. The management of these risks is described above.

Statement of Directors' responsibilities in respect of the financial statements
The Directors are responsible for preparing the Annual Report and the financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulation.

Company law requires the Directors to prepare financial statements for each financial period. Under that law the Directors have prepared the financial statements in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice (United Kingdom Accounting Standards, comprising FRS 101 "Reduced Disclosure Framework", and applicable law). Under company law, Directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the Company and of the profit or loss of the Company for that period. In preparing the financial statements, the Directors are required to:

- select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently;
- state whether applicable United Kingdom Accounting Standards, comprising FRS 101, have been followed, subject to any material departures disclosed and explained in the financial statements;
- make judgements and accounting estimates that are reasonable and prudent; and
- prepare the financial statements on the going concern basis unless it is inappropriate to presume that the Company will continue in business.

The Directors are responsible for safeguarding the assets of the Company and hence for taking reasonable steps for the prevention and detection of fraud and other irregularities.

The Directors are also responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the Company's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the Company and enable them to ensure that the financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006.

Directors' confirmations
In the case of each Director in office at the date the Directors' Report is approved:

- so far as the Director is aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the Company's auditors are unaware; and
- they have taken all the steps that they ought to have taken as a Director in order to make themselves aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that the Company's auditors are aware of that information.

Post balance sheet events

On 28 May 2025, the Group successfully completed its debt refinancing. To strengthen the balance sheet of the Group, certain of the Group's shareholders provided the Group with £20,000,000 of new equity. The proceeds of which the Group used together with £35,000,000 of balance sheet cash, to fund a £55,000,000 pro rata par cash paydown of the existing £335,000,000 senior secured notes.

In addition, the Group announced that it had reached agreement with existing noteholders, to extend maturities of the remaining senior secured notes until September 2029. The extended notes carry a coupon of 9.875% per annum paid biannually.

In connection with the refinancing, the Group has amended and extended the Revolving Credit Facility, whereby £24,750,000 of the existing facility has been extended to March 2029, and the remaining £5,250,000 of the existing facility is available until January 2026.

On completion of the refinancing, the Group now has in place £280,000,000 of Senior Secured Notes at a coupon of 9.875%, together with the Revolving Credit Facility. No accounting was recorded for the period to 29 December 2024 in respect of these changes.

Independent auditors

The independent auditors, PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP, have indicated their willingness to continue in office and a resolution concerning their re-appointment will be proposed at the Annual General Meeting.

This Directors' report was approved by the Board on 10 July 2025 and signed on its behalf of the Board

Colin Elliot

Colin Elliot (Jul 10, 2025 10:43 GMT+1)

.....

C Elliot
Director

PizzaExpress Limited
Statement of Comprehensive Income
For the 52-week period ended 29 December 2024

	Note	52-weeks ended 29 December 2024 £000	52-weeks ended 31 December 2023 £000
Administrative expenses		(11,301)	(4,610)
Operating loss	3	**(11,301)**	**(4,610)**
Finance income	6	10,015	16,891
Finance costs	7	(4,224)	(10,496)
Net finance income		5,791	6,395
(Loss)/Profit before taxation		**(5,510)**	**1,785**
Tax on (loss)/profit	8	203	163
(Loss)/Profit for the financial period		**(5,307)**	**1,948**
Total comprehensive (loss)/income for the period		**(5,307)**	**1,948**

All results arise from the Company's continuing operations.

The notes on pages 8 to 20 are an integral part of these financial statements.

PizzaExpress Limited
Registration Number: 01404552
Statement of Financial Position
As at 29 December 2024

	Note	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Intangible assets	9	489	545
Property, plant and equipment	10	33	33
Investments	11	303	303
Deferred tax asset	12	1,165	1,165
Fixed assets		**1,990**	**2,046**
Trade and other receivables falling due after more than one year	13	1,409	789
Trade and other receivables falling due within one year	13	1,123,072	1,125,035
Cash and cash equivalents	14	17,375	3,435
Current assets		**1,141,856**	**1,129,259**
Trade and other payables falling due within one year	15	(1,211,819)	(1,193,768)
Corporation tax creditor		-	(203)
Current liabilities		**(1,211,819)**	**(1,193,971)**
Net current liabilities		**(69,963)**	**(64,712)**
Total assets less current liabilities		**(67,973)**	**(62,666)**
Trade and other payables falling due after more than one year	15	(6,447)	(6,447)
Preference shares	16	(110)	(110)
Non-current liabilities		**(6,557)**	**(6,557)**
Net liabilities		**(74,530)**	**(69,223)**
Called up share capital	17	7,179	7,179
Share premium account	18	61,869	61,869
Accumulated losses		(143,578)	(138,271)
Total equity		**(74,530)**	**(69,223)**

The notes on pages 8 to 20 are an integral part of these financial statements.

The financial statements on pages 5 to 20 were approved by the Board of Directors on 10 July 2025 and were signed on its behalf by

Colin Elliot

Colin Elliot (Jul 10, 2025 10:43 GMT+1)

.....

C Elliot
Director

	Called up share capital £000	Share premium account £000	Accumulated losses £000	Total equity £000
At 2 January 2023	**7,179**	**61,869**	**(140,219)**	**(71,171)**
Profit for the financial period	-	-	1,948	1,948
Total comprehensive income for the financial period	-	-	1,948	1,948
At 31 December 2023	**7,179**	**61,869**	**(138,271)**	**(69,223)**
At 1 January 2024	**7,179**	**61,869**	**(138,271)**	**(69,223)**
Loss for the financial period	-	-	(5,307)	(5,307)
Total comprehensive loss for the financial period	-	-	(5,307)	(5,307)
At 29 December 2024	**7,179**	**61,869**	**(143,578)**	**(74,530)**

The notes on pages 8 to 20 are an integral part of these financial statements.

1. General information

PizzaExpress Limited is a private limited Company limited by shares domiciled and incorporated in the United Kingdom. The Company is registered in England and the registered office address is Building 01, Arc Uxbridge, Sanderson Road, Uxbridge, UB8 1DH.

The Company is a holding Company.

2. Summary of material accounting policies

The principal accounting policies are outlined below. These policies have been consistently applied to all periods presented, unless otherwise stated.

Basis of preparation
The financial statements have been prepared on a historical costs basis and in accordance with Financial Reporting Standard 101 'Reduced Disclosure Framework' ("FRS 101") and the Companies Act 2006 applicable to companies reporting under FRS 101.

FRS 101 – Reduced disclosure exemptions
The Company has taken advantage of the following disclosure exemptions under FRS 101:

- the requirements of IFRS 7 Financial Instruments: Disclosures
- the requirements of the second sentence of paragraph 110 and paragraphs 113(a), 114, 115, 118, 119(a) to (c), 120 to 127 and 129 of IFRS 15 Revenue from Contracts with Customers
- the requirements of paragraphs 10(d), 16, 38A, 38B, 38C, 38D, 111 and 134-136 of IAS 1 Presentation of financial statements
- the requirements of IAS 7 Statement of Cash Flows
- the requirements of paragraphs 30 and 31 of IAS 8 Accounting Policies, Changes in Accounting Estimates and Errors
- the requirements of paragraph 17 of IAS 24 Related Party Disclosures
- the requirements in IAS 24 Related Party Disclosures to disclose related party transactions entered into between two or more members of a group, provided that any subsidiary which is a party to the transaction is wholly owned by such a member
- the requirements of paragraph 38 of IAS 1 in respect of IAS 16 Property, Plant and Equipment paragraph 73(e) and IAS 38 Intangibles paragraph 118(e)
- the requirements of paragraphs 134(d)-134(f) and 135(c)-135(e) of IAS 36 Impairment of Assets.

The above disclosures can be found in the financial statements of Wheel Bidco Limited and Wheel Topco Limited, the smallest and largest groups respectively in which the financial information of the Company is consolidated.

Going concern
The Directors note that as at 29 December 2024, the Company was in a net liability position of £74,530,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £69,223,000) and a net current liability position of £69,963,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £64,712,000). The Directors consider the business to continue to meet its obligations as they fall due and remain in business for the foreseeable future. The Company has received confirmation from its ultimate parent company, Wheel Topco Limited in respect of the ability of it and the subsidiaries of the Group to provide financial support as required by the Company to enable it to meet its obligations as they fall due for a period of not less than 12 months from the date of signing these financial statements.

The Directors note that as at 29 December 2024, the Group was in a net asset position of £107,127,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £140,190,000) and a net current liability position of £11,553,000 (as at 31 December 2023: £13,089,000). The Directors consider the business is able to continue to meet its obligations as they fall due and remain in business for the foreseeable future.

As at 29 December 2024, the Group has in place £335,000,000 of 6.75% 5 year bonds due to mature in July 2026 (the "Existing Notes"), and an additional revolving credit facility ("RCF") of £30,000,000. At 29 December 2024, £26,000,000 of the RCF is available to be drawn until January 2026, as £4,000,000 is utilised to provide a letter of credit to a utility provider which has not been called (31 December 2023: £26,000,000 undrawn).

On 28 May 2025, the Group successfully completed its debt refinancing. To strengthen the balance sheet of the Group, certain of the Group's shareholders provided the Group with £20,000,000 of new equity. The proceeds of which the Group used together with £35,000,000 of balance sheet cash, to fund a £55,000,000 pro rata par cash paydown of the existing £335,000,000 senior secured notes.

2. Summary of material accounting policies (continued)

Going concern (continued)
In addition, the Group announced that it had reached agreement with existing noteholders, to extend maturities of the remaining senior secured notes until September 2029. The extended notes carry a coupon of 9.875% per annum paid biannually.

In connection with the refinancing, the Group has amended and extended the Revolving Credit Facility, whereby £24,750,000 of the existing facility has been extended to March 2029, and the remaining £5,250,000 of the existing facility is available until January 2026.

On completion of the refinancing, the Group now has in place £280,000,000 of Senior Secured Notes at a coupon of 9.875%, together with the Revolving Credit Facility. No accounting was recorded for the period to 29 December 2024 in respect of these changes.

When forming their opinion on the appropriateness of the going concern basis in preparing the financial statements for the Group, the Directors have considered the Group's financing arrangements, trading patterns and trading risks. The Directors have reviewed financial projections for both a base case and a downside case. The downside case assumes a reduction in revenue and a proportion of cost reductions and efficiencies cannot be achieved, resulting in a lower EBITDA and cash flow.

The Group has sufficient liquidity through trading to finance operations for at least the next 12 months in both the base case and downside case scenarios. The Group could further mitigate its liquidity by reducing discretionary capital expenditure and other spend in the period if required.

Having assessed the financial projections, sensitivities and possible mitigating actions, the Board considers that these appropriately demonstrate the ability of the Group to meet its obligations for at least twelve months from the date of signing these financial statements.

Consolidated financial statements
The Company is a wholly owned subsidiary of PizzaExpress Operations Limited and of its ultimate parent, Wheel Topco Limited. It is included in the consolidated financial statements of Wheel Topco Limited and therefore the Company is exempt by virtue of section 401 of the Companies Act 2006 from the requirement to prepare consolidated financial statements. The registered office of both the largest and smallest groups for which financial statements are prepared is 47 Esplanade St Helier, Jersey JE1 0BD.

These financial statements are separate financial statements.

New standards, amendments and interpretations effective in future periods
In April 2024, the International Accounting Standards Board ("IASB") issued IFRS 18, Presentation and Disclosure in Financial Statements to replace IAS 1, Presentation of the financial statements. The new standard requires that each line item in the income statement is classified into one of five defined categories: operating, investing, financing, income taxes, or discontinued operations and that certain subtotals are presented on the statement of profit or loss.

The amendments are effective for periods beginning on or after 1 January 2027 and we will adopt IFRS 18 upon the effective date with a required retrospective application. We continue to evaluate the impact, and do not currently expect that any other recently issued accounting guidance will have a material impact on the entity in the current or future reporting periods.

New standards effective during the current period
There are no new accounting standards, amendments to accounting standards or interpretations effective during the current period.

Intangible assets
Intangible assets are initially recognised at cost. After recognition, under the cost model, intangible assets are measured at cost less any accumulated amortisation and any accumulated impairment losses.

Amortisation is provided at the following annual rates in order to write down to estimated residual values the cost of each asset over its estimated useful economic life on a straight-line basis:

Trademarks	
	Life of trademark

2. Summary of material accounting policies (continued)

Property, plant and equipment
Property, plant and equipment are stated at original historical purchase cost less accumulated depreciation.

Cost includes the original purchase price of the asset and the costs directly attributable to bringing the asset to its working condition for its intended use.

Depreciation is provided at the following annual rates in order to write down the cost of each asset over its estimated useful economic life on a straight-line basis:

Freehold property	2% per annum

Assets under construction comprise tangible fixed assets that are part of projects in progress, including costs directly attributable to bringing the assets into use. Assets are transferred to the relevant fixed asset category once the assets are brought into use. No depreciation is provided on assets under construction, as these assets have not been brought into working condition for intended use.

Impairment of property, plant and equipment
The carrying values of tangible fixed assets are reviewed for impairment by the Directors at each balance sheet date or in periods where events or changes in circumstances indicate that the carrying value may not be recoverable. Any impairment in the value of assets below depreciated cost is charged to the profit and loss account within operating profit. A reversal of an impairment loss is recognised in the profit and loss account up to the extent that the original loss was recognised.

Finance costs
Finance costs are charged to the statement of comprehensive income over the term of the debt using the effective interest rate method so that the amount charged is at a constant rate on the carrying amount. Issue costs are initially recognised as a reduction in the proceeds of the associated capital instrument.

Finance income
Finance income is recognised in the statement of comprehensive income using the effective interest method.

Taxation
The tax expense represents the sum of current tax and deferred tax.

Current taxation
Current tax payable is based on taxable profit for the period which differs from accounting profit as reported in the statement of comprehensive income because it excludes items of income or expense that are taxable or deductible in other years and those items never taxable or deductible. The Company's liability for current tax is measured using tax rates that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the reporting date.

Deferred taxation

Deferred tax is the tax expected to be payable or recoverable on differences between the carrying amount of assets and liabilities in the financial statements and the corresponding tax base used in the computation of taxable profit, and is accounted for using the balance sheet liability method.

Deferred tax liabilities are recognised for all taxable temporary differences and deferred tax assets are recognised to the extent that it is probable that future taxable profits will be available against which deductible temporary differences can be utilised. Such assets and liabilities are not recognised if the temporary difference arises from the initial recognition of goodwill or from the initial recognition (other than in a business combination) of other assets and liabilities in a transaction which affects neither the taxable profit nor the accounting profit.

Deferred tax is calculated at the substantively enacted tax rates at the balance sheet date that are expected to apply to the year when the asset is realised, or the liability is settled. Deferred tax is charged or credited in comprehensive income, except when it relates to items credited or charged directly to equity, in which case the deferred tax is dealt with in equity, or items charged or credited directly to other comprehensive income, in which case the deferred tax is also recognised in other comprehensive income.

Deferred tax assets and liabilities are offset when there is a legally enforceable right to set off current tax assets and liability and when the Company intends to settle its current tax assets and liabilities on a net asset basis.

2. Summary of material accounting policies (continued)

Valuation of investments
Investments in subsidiaries are measured at cost less accumulated impairment.

Cash and cash equivalents
Cash and cash equivalents comprise cash at bank and in hand and short-term deposits with maturities of less than three months.

Financial instruments
Financial assets and financial liabilities are recognised when the Company has become a party to the contractual provisions of the instrument. Financial instruments are de-recognised when they are discharged or when the contractual terms expire. The Company's accounting policies in respect of financial instruments transactions are explained below:

Financial assets
Financial assets comprise cash and cash equivalents and trade and other receivables. The Company classifies all of its financial assets as assets at amortised cost as they are held within a business model with the objective to collect contractual cash flows and these contractual cash flows represent 'solely payments of principal and interest' on the principal amount outstanding (the 'SPPI criterion'). They are initially recognised at fair value plus transaction costs that are directly attributable to their acquisition or issue, and are subsequently carried at amortised cost using the effective interest rate method, less provision for impairment.

Impairment provisions are recognised using an expected credit loss approach. The expected credit loss is the difference between the cash flows that are due to the Company in accordance with the contract and the cash flows that the Company expects to receive discounted at the original effective interest rate. In calculating the expected credit loss rates, the Company considers historical loss rates for each category of customers and adjusts for forward-looking macroeconomic data. The Company used the simplified expected credit loss model (the lifetime expected loss allowance) for receivables that do not have a significant financing component. Any short-term trade receivables are assumed to not have a significant financing component. For long term intercompany receivables where there has not been a significant deterioration in credit quality since the initial recognition of the receivable, impairment is assessed using the 12-month expected credit loss approach. Where it is determined that there has been a significant deterioration in credit quality, the lifetime expected credit loss approach is used.

Financial liabilities
Financial liabilities comprise borrowings and trade and other payables. The Company classifies all of its financial liabilities as liabilities at amortised cost. Financial liabilities at amortised cost are initially recognised at fair value net of any transaction costs directly attributable to the issue of the instrument.

The Company does not hold or issue derivative financial instruments for trading purposes.

Foreign currency translation
The Company's functional and presentational currency is GBP. Foreign currency transactions are translated into the functional currency using the spot exchange rates at the dates of the transactions. At each period end, foreign currency monetary items are translated using the closing rate. Non-monetary items measured at historical cost are translated using the exchange rate at the date of the transaction and non-monetary items measured at fair value are measured using the exchange rate when fair value was determined.

Foreign exchange gains and losses resulting from the settlement of transactions and from the translation at period end exchange rates of monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies are recognised in the statement of comprehensive income and presented within administrative expenses.

Critical accounting estimates and areas of judgement
The preparation of the financial statements in conformity with FRS 101 requires management to make estimates and assumptions that affect the application of policies and reported amounts of assets, liabilities, income, expenses and related disclosures. The estimates and underlying assumptions are based on historical experience and other relevant factors. This approach forms the basis of making the judgements about carrying values of assets and liabilities that are not readily apparent from other sources. Actual results may differ from these estimates.

The estimates and underlying assumptions are reviewed on an ongoing basis. Changes in accounting estimates may be necessary if there are changes in the circumstances on which the estimate was based or as a result of new information. Such changes are recognised in the year in which the estimate is revised.

The key assumptions about the future and key sources of estimation uncertainty that have a risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying value of assets and liabilities in more than 12 months, are described below.

2. Summary of material accounting policies (continued)

Critical accounting estimates and areas of judgement (continued)

Significant judgement: carrying value of investments

Where there is an indication that investments are impaired, they are tested for impairment by calculating the actual future expected discounted cash flows to be received. Where this is lower than carrying value, an impairment is recognised.

Significant judgement: recoverability of intercompany receivables

Intercompany receivables are tested for impairment by taking into account the liquidity of the intercompany counterparty, as well as historical experience. An impairment is recognised if the cash flows that are expected to be received, discounted at the original effective interest rate where applicable, are lower than the cash flows that are due to the Company.

3. Operating loss

Operating loss has been arrived at after charging/(crediting):

	52-weeks ended 29 December 2024 £000	52-weeks ended 31 December 2023 £000
Impairment provision for amounts owed from group undertakings (note 13)	11,182	4,468
Amortisation of intangible assets (note 9)	124	120
Exchange differences	(5)	22

The audit fee of £9,900 (period ended 31 December 2023: £9,500) for the Company for the period was borne by and included within the financial statements of PizzaExpress Group Limited, an intermediate parent Company.

4. Employees

The Company has no employees other than the Directors (period ended 31 December 2023: nil)

5. Directors' remuneration

No remuneration was paid by the Company to any Director during the period (period ended 31 December 2023: £nil). All Directors were remunerated by PizzaExpress Group Limited during the period and no recharge has been made to the Company.

The Company does not operate a defined benefit pension scheme and did not make any contributions to defined contribution pension schemes for Directors (period ended 31 December 2023: £nil). No Directors had any interests in any options for shares in the Company (period ended 31 December 2023: £nil).

6. Finance income

	52-weeks ended 29 December 2024 £000	52-weeks ended 31 December 2023 £000
Interest receivable from group companies	9,822	16,853
Other interest receivable	193	38
	10,015	16,891

7. Finance costs

	52-weeks ended 29 December 2024	52-weeks ended 31 December 2023
	£000	£000
Interest expense to group companies	4,211	10,496
Other interest payable	13	-
	4,224	10,496

8. Tax on (loss)/profit

	52-weeks ended 29 December 2024	52-weeks ended 31 December 2023
	£000	£000
Deferred tax		
Adjustments in respect of previous periods	(203)	(163)
Tax on (loss)/profit	(203)	(163)

The tax assessed for the period is higher (period ended 31 December 2023: lower) than the standard rate of corporation tax in the United Kingdom of 25.0% (period ended 31 December 2023: 23.5%). The differences are reconciled below:

	52-weeks ended 29 December 2024	52-weeks ended 31 December 2023
	£000	£000
(Loss)/profit before taxation	(5,510)	1,785
(Loss)/profit multiplied by standard rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25.0% (52-week period ended 31 December 2023 - 23.5%)	(1,378)	419
Effects of:		
Change in UK tax rate		-
Adjustments in respect of previous periods	(203)	(163)
Group relief	(1,417)	(1,469)
Expenses not deductible for tax purposes	2,795	1,050
Total tax credit for the period	(203)	(163)

8. Tax on (loss)/profit continued

Factors that may affect future tax charges
The impact of the increase in corporation tax rate from 19% to 25% (effective 1 April 2023) was disclosed within the 52-week period ended 31 December 2023 financial statements. We continue to recognise deferred tax at the substantively enacted rate of 25% within these financial statements and any rate changes disclosures are in relation to the differences in tax rates between the prior period tax rate at 23.5% and deferred tax rate at 25%.

9. Intangible assets

	Trademarks £000
Cost	
At 1 January 2024	1,309
Additions	68
At 29 December 2024	**1,377**
Accumulated amortisation	
At 1 January 2024	(764)
Charge for the period	(124)
At 29 December 2024	**(888)**
Net book value	
At 29 December 2024	**489**
At 31 December 2023	545

Additions during the period relate to trademark fees for new territories.

Intangible assets amortisation is recorded in administrative expenses in the Statement of Comprehensive Income.

10. Property, plant and equipment

	Freehold Property £000
Cost	
At 1 January 2024	41
At 29 December 2024	**41**
Accumulated depreciation	
At 1 January 2024	(8)
At 29 December 2024	**(8)**
Net book value	
At 29 December 2024	**33**
At 31 December 2023	33

Refer to note 20 for details of guarantees provided over the assets held by the Company.

11. Investments

	Investments in subsidiaries £000
Cost	
At 29 December 2024 and 31 December 2023	779
Accumulated impairment	
At 29 December 2024 and 31 December 2023	(476)
Net book value	
At 29 December 2024 and 31 December 2023	303

The following were subsidiary undertakings of the Company during the period:

Name	Class of Share	Holding	Country of incorporation
Bookcash Trading Limited*	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom
PizzaExpress Newco Limited*	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom
PizzaExpress (Restaurants) Limited	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom
PizzaExpress (Wholesale) Limited	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom
PizzaExpress Merchandising Limited	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom
PizzaExpress (Jersey) Limited	Ordinary	100%	Jersey
Agenbite Limited	Ordinary	100%	Ireland
PizzaExpress (West) Limited	Ordinary	100%	Jersey
Roll&Shake Limited	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom
Hunton House Limited	Ordinary	100%	United Kingdom

*Indirectly held. The shares of all other investments are directly held.

The registered address of all subsidiaries incorporated in the United Kingdom is Building 01, Arc Uxbridge, Sanderson Road, Uxbridge, UB8 1DH.

The registered address of all other subsidiaries is outlined below:

Name	Registered address
Agenbite Limited	A38 Main Street, Swords, Dublin, County Dublin, Republic of Ireland
PizzaExpress (Jersey) Limited	PO Box 179, 40 Esplanade, St Helier, Jersey, Channel Islands, JE4 9RJ
PizzaExpress (West) Limited	PO Box 179, 40 Esplanade, St Helier, Jersey, Channel Islands, JE4 9RJ

12. Deferred tax asset

	Capital allowances	Unused tax losses	Total
	£000	£000	£000
At 2 January 2023	1	1,000	1,001
Credited to the statement of comprehensive income	-	164	164
Impact of changes in UK tax rate	-	-	-
			-
At 31 December 2023	1	1,164	1,165
Credited to the statement of comprehensive income	-	-	-
Impact of changes in UK tax rate	-	-	-
At 29 December 2024	1	1,164	1,165
As at 29 December 2024, recognised in:			
Deferred tax asset	1	1,164	1,165
Deferred tax liability	-	-	-
	1	1,164	1,165
As at 31 December 2023, recognised in:			
Deferred tax asset	1	1,164	1,165
Deferred tax liability	-	-	-
	1	1,164	1,165

The Company expects the deferred tax asset to reverse after more than 12 months.

13. Trade and other receivables

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Amounts falling due after more than one year		
Amounts owed by group undertakings	1,409	789
	1,409	789

A £8,495,000 (52-week period ended 31 December 2023: £8,495,000) provision for impairment was held in relation to amounts owed by group undertakings.

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Amounts falling due within one year		
Amounts owed by group undertakings	1,123,072	1,125,035
	1,123,072	1,125,035

A £69,224,000 (52-week period ended 31 December 2023: £58,042,000) provision for impairment was held in relation to amounts owed by group undertakings.

Amounts owed by group undertakings less than three years old and greater than one year old were charged at an interest rate of 8.7% per annum (52-week period ended 31 December 2023: 8.2% per annum) and no interest was charged on amounts less than one year old or greater than three years old. All balances are repayable on demand.

The interest rate used is based on a 1 year fixed rate determined using a 3 year margin + 1 year swap rate which will be updated annually. This policy reflects an arm's length interest rate applicable to short term intercompany financing, with the principal purpose being the funding of working capital.

14. Cash and cash equivalents

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Cash at bank and in hand	17,375	3,435
	17,375	3,435

15. Trade and other payables

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Amounts owed to group undertakings	6,447	6,447
	6,447	6,447

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Amounts falling due within one year		
Trade payables	7	36
Amounts owed to group undertakings	1,199,900	1,181,430
Taxation and social security	11,912	12,302
	1,211,819	1,193,768

Amounts owed to group undertakings less than three years old and greater than one year old were charged at an interest rate of 8.7% per annum (52-week period ended 31 December 2023: 8.2% per annum) and no interest was charged on amounts less than one year old or greater than three years old. All balances are repayable on demand.

The interest rate used is based on a 1 year fixed rate determined using a 3 year margin + 1 year swap rate which will be updated annually. This policy reflects an arm's length interest rate applicable to short term intercompany financing, with the principal purpose being the funding of working capital.

16. Preference shares

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Preference shares	110	110
	110	110

The deferred convertible shares are interest free and have no fixed date of repayment. The fair value of the deferred convertible shares is estimated to be approximately £110,000 (period ended 31 December 2023: £110,000).

The deferred convertible shares were held by previous employees of the Company and were convertible to ordinary shares on a one for one basis two years after the date of issue provided the earnings per share had increased by at least RPI plus 5% per annum over the relevant period. These conditions were not met and hence the shares are no longer convertible into ordinary share capital. Deferred convertible shares have no voting rights and do not qualify for dividend payments.

17. Called up share capital

	29 December 2024		31 December 2023	
	No.	£000	No.	£000
Called up share capital				
71,788,348 (Period ended 31 December 2023: 71,788,348) Ordinary shares of £0.10 each	71,788,348	7,179	71,788,348	7,179

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Shares classified as debt		
Allotted, called up and partly paid		
2,200,000 (Period ended 31 December 2023: 2,200,000) Convertible shares of £0.05 each	110	110

18. Share premium account

Share premium account	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Share premium	61,869	61,869

19. Financial instruments

	29 December 2024 £000	31 December 2023 £000
Financial assets		
Trade and other receivables	1,124,481	1,125,824
Cash and cash equivalents	17,375	3,435
	1,141,856	1,129,259
Financial liabilities		
Trade and other payables	1,199,851	1,181,466
Loans and borrowings	6,447	6,447
	1,206,298	1,187,913

20. Contingent liabilities

As at 29 December 2024, the Company is a guarantor to July 2026 Notes issued by its intermediate parent company Wheel Bidco Limited. This guarantee is over all of the assets held by the Company.

The amounts outstanding at balance sheet date in relation to these Notes were £343,056,000 (31 December 2023: £341,766,000), including accrued interest.

On 28 May 2025, the Group completed a refinancing of the July 2026 Notes. On completion, as at 28 May 2025 the Group has in place £280,000,000 of Senior Secured Notes, for which the company is a guarantor.

21. Related party transactions

The Company has taken advantage of the exemption available under FRS 101, Section 8, not to disclose transactions with wholly owned subsidiaries of Wheel Topco Limited.

There were no other related party transactions to disclose.

22. Controlling Parties

As at 29 December 2024, the immediate parent of PizzaExpress Limited is PizzaExpress Operations Limited, a Company which is an indirect subsidiary of Wheel Topco Limited, a limited Company under the laws of Jersey and the largest group for which consolidated financial statements are prepared. The financial statements of Wheel Topco Limited are available from the Company Secretary, 47 Esplanade St Helier, Jersey JE1 0BD.

The ultimate beneficial parent of PizzaExpress Limited is Wheel Topco Limited.

Report on the Audit of the Financial Statements

Opinion

In our opinion, PizzaExpress Limited's financial statements:

- give give a true and fair view of the state of the company's affairs as at 29 December 2024 and of its loss for the 52 week period then ended;
- have been properly prepared in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice (United Kingdom Accounting Standards, including FRS 101 "Reduced Disclosure Framework", and applicable law); and
- have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

We have audited the financial statements, included within the Annual Report and Financial statements (the "Annual Report"), which comprise: the Statement of Financial Position as at 29 December 2024; the Statement of Comprehensive Income and the Statement of Changes in Equity for the period then ended; and the notes to the financial statements, comprising material accounting policy information and other explanatory information.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) ("ISAs (UK)") and applicable law. Our responsibilities under ISAs (UK) are further described in the Auditors' responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements section of our report. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Independence

We remained independent of the company in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in the UK, which includes the FRC's Ethical Standard, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements.

Conclusions relating to going concern

Based on the work we have performed, we have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.

In auditing the financial statements, we have concluded that the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.

However, because not all future events or conditions can be predicted, this conclusion is not a guarantee as to the company's ability to continue as a going concern.

Our responsibilities and the responsibilities of the directors with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this report.

Reporting on other information

The other information comprises all of the information in the Annual Report other than the financial statements and our auditors' report thereon. The directors are responsible for the other information. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, accordingly, we do not express an audit opinion or, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in this report, any form of assurance thereon.

Reporting on other information (continued)

In connection with our audit of the financial statements, our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or our knowledge obtained in the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If we identify an apparent material inconsistency or material misstatement, we are required to perform procedures to conclude whether there is a material misstatement of the financial statements or a material misstatement of the other information. If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact. We have nothing to report based on these responsibilities.

With respect to the Strategic report and Directors' Report, we also considered whether the disclosures required by the UK Companies Act 2006 have been included.

Based on our work undertaken in the course of the audit, the Companies Act 2006 requires us also to report certain opinions and matters as described below.

Strategic report and Directors' Report

In our opinion, based on the work undertaken in the course of the audit, the information given in the Strategic report and Directors' Report for the period ended 29 December 2024 is consistent with the financial statements and has been prepared in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

In light of the knowledge and understanding of the company and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, we did not identify any material misstatements in the Strategic report and Directors' Report.

Responsibilities for the financial statements and the audit

Responsibilities of the Directors for the financial statements

As explained more fully in the Statement of Directors' responsibilities in respect of the financial statements, the directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements in accordance with the applicable framework and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view. The directors are also responsible for such internal control as they determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, the directors are responsible for assessing the company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the directors either intend to liquidate the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditors' responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditors' report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

Irregularities, including fraud, are instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations. We design procedures in line with our responsibilities, outlined above, to detect material misstatements in respect of irregularities, including fraud. The extent to which our procedures are capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud, is detailed below.

Auditors' responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements (continued)

Based on our understanding of the company and industry, we identified that the principal risks of non-compliance with laws and regulations related to the Companies Act 2006 and UK tax legislation, and we considered the extent to which non-compliance might have a material effect on the financial statements. We evaluated management's incentives and opportunities for fraudulent manipulation of the financial statements (including the risk of override of controls), and determined that the principal risks were related to posting of inappropriate journal entries outside the normal course of business and management bias in accounting estimates and judgements. Audit procedures performed by the engagement team included:

- Discussions with management and the Company's legal team, including consideration of known or suspected instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations and fraud;
- Testing of journal entries for appropriateness, testing of accounting estimates (because of the risk of management bias), and evaluating the business rationale of significant transactions outside the normal course of business; and
- Reviewing minutes of meetings of those charged with governance and reviewing correspondence with regulators

There are inherent limitations in the audit procedures described above. We are less likely to become aware of instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations that are not closely related to events and transactions reflected in the financial statements. Also, the risk of not detecting a material misstatement due to fraud is higher than the risk of not detecting one resulting from error, as fraud may involve deliberate concealment by, for example, forgery or intentional misrepresentations, or through collusion.

A further description of our responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements is located on the FRC's website at: www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities. This description forms part of our auditors' report.

Use of this report

This report, including the opinions, has been prepared for and only for the company's members as a body in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006 and for no other purpose. We do not, in giving these opinions, accept or assume responsibility for any other purpose or to any other person to whom this report is shown or into whose hands it may come save where expressly agreed by our prior consent in writing.

Other required reporting

Companies Act 2006 exception reporting

Under the Companies Act 2006 we are required to report to you if, in our opinion:

- we have not obtained all the information and explanations we require for our audit; or
- adequate accounting records have not been kept by the company, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us; or
- certain disclosures of directors' remuneration specified by law are not made; or
- the financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns.

We have no exceptions to report arising from this responsibility.

Matthew Mullins (Senior Statutory Auditor)
for and on behalf of PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP
Chartered Accountants and Statutory Auditors
Watford
11 July 2025